MUSICAL ▼

# *Summer of Love*

An English musical adaptation of *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge*, being staged in Manchester currently, is a cross-cultural celebration set to infectious beats

This summer, Opera House Manchester invites audiences on a whirlwind journey of love, laughter and cultural discovery with the UK premiere of *Come Fall in Love*, running from May 29 to June 21. From the co-writer of *Legally Blonde* and lyricist of *Mean Girls*, and adapted from India's most beloved blockbuster *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge* (*DDLJ*), this joyous new musical promises to sweep you off your feet. Blending the heart of Bollywood with the sparkle of the West End, *Come Fall in Love* stars Jena Pandya (*Mamma Mia!*, *Bhangra Nation*) and Ashley Day (*Dynasty*, *An American in Paris*), in a romcom that bridges continents and cultures.

The story follows Simran, a young British woman poised for an arranged marriage in India, as she embarks on a European summer escape. Enter Roger—a carefree, party-loving traveller—and an unexpected romance blooms. But can their love withstand tradition, distance and disapproving parents? Directed by Aditya Chopra, the original film's visionary, the musical whisks audiences from Paris and Rome to the golden fields of Punjab. With 18 brand-new English songs, music by Bollywood legends Vishal Dadlani and Sheykhar Ravjiani, choreography by the award-winning Rob Ashford, and Indian dance by Shruti Merchant, it's a cross-cultural celebration set to infectious beats and breathtaking staging, with scenic design by Derek McLane.

Opera House Manchester, a majestic venue first opened in 1912, provides the perfect setting for this vibrant spectacle. A former cinema and bingo hall, the theatre was restored to its original glory in the 1980s and has since hosted some of the UK's finest touring productions. With its gilded proscenium and rich theatrical history, it promises a grand stage for this Bollywood-meets-Britain love story. ■

***—Nikhil Sardana***

**Directed by Aditya Chopra, the musical stars Jena Pandya and Ashley Day**



COMEDY ▶

# LAUGHTER IS THE BEST MEDICINE

**Sumukhi Suresh's stand-up special *Hormonal* is equal parts catharsis and comedy**




THEATRE ▼

# IDENTITY CRISIS

**Queer-themed play *Cock*, which raises questions about sexuality and love, has been revived by Shweta Tripathi and Manish Gandhi**

It was 14 years ago that *Cock* won a number of prestigious awards at the Thespo National Theatre Festival 2011, including Best Actor and Best Actress. The Olivier Award-winning play written by British playwright Mike Bartlett was directed by Manish Gandhi and produced by actor Shweta Tripathi. The latter also debuted her AllMyTea Productions with this show. All